AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII

ANNUAL EXAMINATIONS (THEORY) 2025

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 5 minutes Marks: 60

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INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's Signature**

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2. There are FOUR questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 3 offers TWO choices and Question 4 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   Do not use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   DO NOT write outside the answer box.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 17 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and answer all the questions that follow.

TEXT A

When the English archaeologist Howard Carter discovered the royal tomb of Tutankhamen in Egypt in November 1922, it took fully eight days to unwrap the mummified body of the young king from 16 layers of linen. To get at the body, amulets and jewellery among the bandages and more violent methods were employed by Carter and his team such as heated knives to take off the golden mask from the decapitated skull of the king. The linen, however, was considered by Carter an impediment to be brushed aside, an opinion that would have horrified the ancient Egyptians to whom linen was imbued with powerful even magical meaning. Mummification was associated in their art with the divine. It was what made mummies sacred.

This is just one of the many illuminating stories contained in '*The Golden Thread*', a thematic history of fabrics by design and culture writer Kassia St Clair who points out that the world's earliest fabrics were made by human hand 34,000 years ago. Social divisions, St Clair emphasises, have long been codified using cloth. This means that luxurious display through the fabric of one's clothing was a way of expressing power. Furthermore, language and cloth are interwoven with each other. In other words, the interface between text and textile is fertile ground for literary critics who 'unpick', 'piece together' or 'unravel', while other phrases are also rooted in textile crafts like 'being on tenterhooks' or 'a knotty problem'.

Like silk, wool was a money spinner in Europe. "The wool trade made [Europeans] wealthy in the 12th and 13th century and also made them worldly", comments St Clair. Wool encouraged speculation and profiteering and widened the gap between the richest and poorest. As wool defined the social status of different groups throughout history, lace also has its own intricate history and cult status. A craft associated with women and incredibly complex designs, the fabric was passed down across many generations. It was a luxury item used to display wealth, taste and rank.

The pre-eminent fabric of the West, however, was cotton. The story of cotton, the fortunes made and the horror of the African slave market and the fact that from the 1790s to the 1860s, the lives of many millions of American slaves were determined by the cotton trade are well documented. Even today cotton clothing makes shocking demands on the environment as a single pair of jeans requires 11,000 litres of water. The book concludes that the fabrics we choose and where we get them from still have consequences on the lives of those who produce them.

Source: Adapted from '*The Golden Thread: How Fabric Changed History – a Riveting Yarn*' by Deirdre McQuillan

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TEXT B



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Source: Taken from https://venngage-wordpress.s3.amazonaws.com/uploads/2017/06/process-infographic-4.png

a. Mention any FOUR evidences in Text A that signify the use of historical information. (4 Marks)

b. The author of Text A states that 'a single pair of jeans requires 11,000 litres of water'. This means that there are many fabrics and clothing items that pose a threat to the environment.

Keeping in mind the issues of environment and the rising temperature of Earth, suggest TWO ways in which fashion can be made environmental friendly. Give a reason for each way. (4 Marks)

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c. Describe the main idea of Text A in your OWN words.

Note: Avoid using or copying entire sentences or phrases from the text in your answers. (3 Marks)

d. Text B shows some of the clothing items people use in winters. In your opinion, which item from the text can be utilised by people in summers and how? (2 Marks)

e. State, in TWO points, how the information is presented in Text B. (2 Marks)

f. Draw any TWO similarities between Texts A and B. (2 Marks)

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Q.2. (Total 10 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and fill in each of the blanks with only **ONE** suitable word.

Mir Muhammad Taqi Mir is (1) _____ major Urdu poet with a vast corpus* of poetry consisting (2) _____ more than thirteen thousand couplets. Mainly a ghazal poet, (3) _____ expertise at other subgenres of poetry such as the *masnavi* (a long poem in rhyming couplets), *qasida* (a kind of ode), and *rubais* (a verse of four-line stanzas) was also remarkable.

Mir's *Kulliyaat* (collected works) (4) _____ published in 1811 by Fort William College, a year after his death. He is called *Khuda-e-Sukhan*, or god of Urdu poetry, (5) _____ his versatility and the high esteem in which he is held by poets (6) _____ came after him. However, intuitive judgments and subjective assessments apart, it is not always easy to pinpoint the reasons for Mir's greatness…

Early on in his life, Mir learnt important lessons (7) _____ his father Ali Muttaqi, a man of Sufi leanings, about the role of love and beauty in life, ephemeral nature of the world and the need to (8) _____ steadfast in the face of odds and vicissitudes in life. Mir also faced the hostility of his brother, who instigated Sirajuddin Ali Khan-e-Arzu in whose house Mir had (9) _____ refuge when he left Agra and came to Delhi…

Mir was pre-eminently a poet of love…Mir (10) _____ conversational and colloquial language in his poetry, which contributed to his popularity.

*corpus (n): quantity or body of work

Source: Taken from an article on Mir Taqi Mir

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Q.3. (Total 15 Marks)

Compose a formal piece of writing of around 250-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a** or **b**.

EITHER

a. A reputable law firm is looking for a manager for its communications department.

Compose a résumé and a covering letter for the mentioned job vacancy. In your letter

- discuss TWO skills or previous experiences that show your suitability for the role.
- describe a certified course or training you have taken that are aligned with the job vacancy.

OR

b. Your class teacher has assigned you to write a report on the future of hybrid learning in Pakistan. Hybrid learning is an approach to educational practice that combines online learning and physical classrooms. In your report,

- state the advantage of hybrid learning for Pakistani students and teachers.
- discuss a challenge that Pakistani students and teachers may encounter.
- suggest TWO ways to address the challenge.

Make your notes below or on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 8, 9 and 10.

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Option _____

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Q.4. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 350-400 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b** or **c.**
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. In this digital and fast paced world, the percentage of people who read books has significantly decreased. Write an essay on the importance of reading books. In your essay,

- discuss THREE benefits of reading books.
- suggest TWO ways in which people can incorporate reading in their busy lives.

OR

b. Compose an essay about your entire academic journey or student life in college. In your essay,

- describe the journey. Include at least 3 adjectives in your description.
- discuss TWO challenges you faced during this journey.
- elaborate how a mentor or a guiding figure helped you through the challenging times.

OR

c. Urbanisation is an increase in the human population as a result of migration from rural to urban areas. It is one of the major causes that is adversely impacting the environment. Write an essay on the given issue. In your essay,

- explain the reason why people are moving from rural to urban areas in great numbers.
- analyse TWO consequences of urbanisation on the environment.
- discuss TWO strategies to counter urbanisation and make the environment sustainable for the future.

Make your notes below or on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 12, 13 and 14.

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Option _____

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END OF PAPER

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